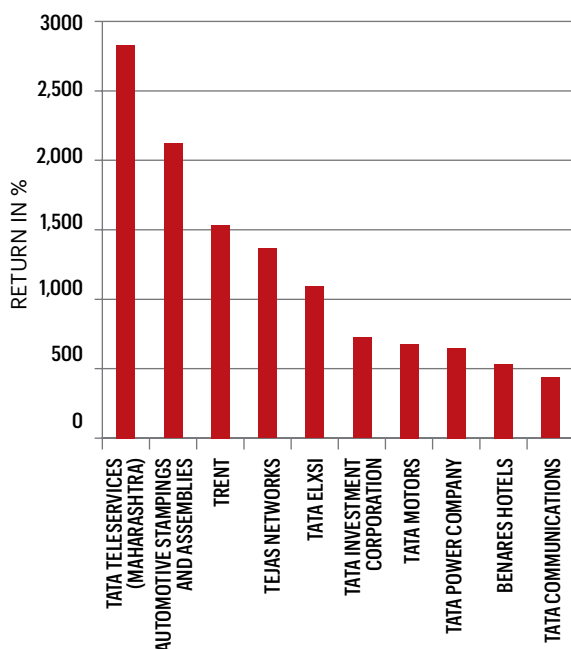


ON THE MARKET

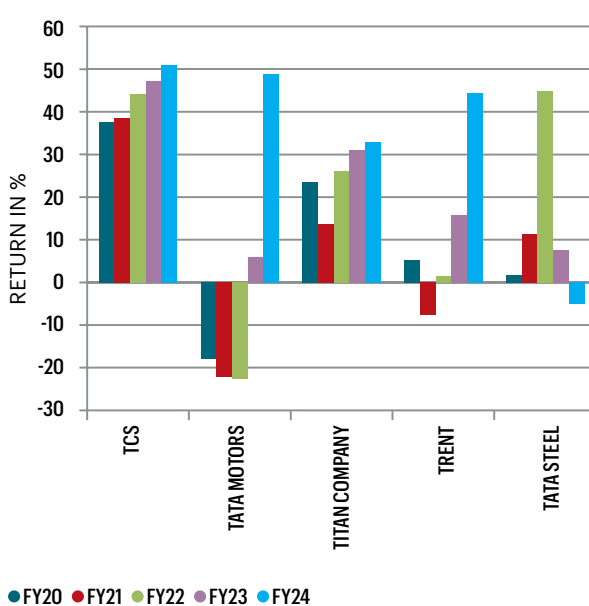
● Tata Teleservices (Maharashtra) has delivered the best returns over the past five years

5-year returns in %



● In terms of return on equity, TCS has consistently outperformed other group firms

ROE of Top 5 Tata firms by market cap in past five years



ROE ON CONSOLIDATED BASIS; DATA AS OF OCTOBER 9
SOURCE ACE EQUITY

role in bolstering the group's finances is unlikely to change anytime soon.

THE MISTRY SAGA

Through RNT's time as the patriarch of the group, many attempts were made to find successors. An example is Dilip Pendse, once RNT's protégé, who headed Tata Finance. He was accused of routing deposit holders' money to the stock market. "He trusted people, and when they let him down, he took it personally. The relationship would then go to the other extreme," says another executive who worked closely with him.

But nothing generated more controversy than the sudden ouster of Cyrus Mistry as Tata Sons' Chairman in October 2016. After being handpicked by RNT, Mistry, whose family owns 18.4% of Tata Sons, succeeded him in 2012, only for his term to be abruptly cut short four years later. RNT then came in as interim Chairman before N. Chandrasekaran—then the TCS

boss—was given the top job.

The battle between Mistry and Tata Sons was played out very publicly and in courts after he was removed from the chairmanship of Tata Sons, and then various group companies. At the heart of the issue was the power exercised by Tata Trusts, which has a 66% stake in Tata Sons, the group's principal investment holding company. "In a sense, they are the 'owners', and thus, logically, have a role to play in setting the group's direction," explains Bhasin. Mistry had said that he did not have a free hand and there were many points of disagreement with Tata Trusts.

An amendment made to Tata Sons' articles of association in 2022 has ensured that one person cannot be the Chairman of both Tata Trusts and Tata Sons. RNT was the last one to have held both posts.

Now, with the appointment of RNT's half-brother Noel Tata, 67, as Tata Trusts' Chairman, the succession seems clearer. Noel Tata has run Trent competently, apart from now being on the boards of Voltas, Titan,